

ChatGPT attacks the spine (v1.3), step 3 round three

Received 2026-08-31, verbatim except that em dashes are normalised to colons per the house rule.
Attachments were the v1.3 spine pdf and both earlier findings pdfs. This was the last round before prose.
Disposition per finding is in the status table; repairs are in spine v1.4.

Status

#	Finding	Status	Repair (v1.4)
1	Margo holds the money fact from Day -1450, so the contradiction is hers on Day 19, not Day 51; the Day 51 file check moved the device, not the possession	Accepted, and it names the load-bearing lock honestly	Margo sees the inconsistency on Day 19 and says nothing for six weeks. The spine now says so. Her refusal is character-supplied and has three world-supplied reasons: the money is a dead friend's undeclared inheritance told in confidence, and reporting it makes Violet a tax cheat and drags the sister; Violet lied fluently and Margo cannot yet tell which of them was lied to; and an allegation names nobody, so she wants the who before she blows up the four. The Day 51 file check stays as the figure (mother's sum against the tin) that ends her doubt. The loading-bay camera is removed as a route: it covers vehicles in the bay, not the corridor door (R25's shape), so the C9 "tapes expire" row goes. The fishmonger route under an allegation remains and would deliver Brad on about Day 30 if she went; she does not, and the spine pays for it with Brad's escape and her death
2	Del on Day 290 holds Tessa's line and the fishmonger's tip; under R27 that is a hypothesis, so she canvasses and Brad becomes the suspected swapper before episode six	Accepted, harmless, and useful	New C7 row, Day 292: Del takes the fishmonger's statement, holds "Brad may have swapped it" privately, can charge nobody, cannot reopen Violet on a visit to a cage, runs Brad Collins for activity and finds none. She is primed for Day 327. Nothing reaches Ally from the file and nothing reaches Brad
3	The landlady's earliest action is local police, and C8 says that puts a constable on her doorstep	Answered: both routes end in arrest; the premise settled which she takes	C8 row rewritten with both routes computed. Local police on Day 326: a constable asks the lodger his name, gets the deckhand's name, runs it, and hits the file Del revived on Day 312; arrest, faster, with the constable on her doorstep while Brad is in the house. Ally on Day 326: Del, the other force, arrest on Day 333, and she is never seen to have moved. Ally's standing instruction on air supplies the choice; v8 settled "tips to Del and never on air"
4	A5 still says the skipper reported the deckhand "lodged with" Brad	Accepted	A5 line corrected to the drinking association

Also carried: GPT's whole-graph table (earliest day each person can hold two facts naming Brad) agrees with Parts B and C; the rucksack repair, the card, the faceless identity and the revived file all hold.

The response, verbatim

Verdict: REWORK

1. **B1 row 2 + B3 rows 30 and 33 / C5 / C9, Day 19: Margo. Confidence 100%.** Margo already lawfully holds Violet's account that the cash came from her mother when she reads the forged claim that Liam supplied it quarterly; by Day 21 she can take the contradiction and letters to Del, whose first

mandatory action is preserving the identified, expiring loading-bay footage before the R22 examination, capturing Brad on Days 16 and 18. Round Two finding 1 remains open because the repair moved Margo's file check, not her possession of the fact.

Wrong if: Margo cannot remember the source and cannot lawfully consult her file before Day 51 for a world-supplied reason; Part B currently makes her the continuous holder from Day –1450.

1. **B4 row 42 + B6 row 57 / C7, Day 290: Del. Confidence 100%.** Del already lawfully holds Tessa's Day 240 statement that "the thing in the cupboard is wrong" when Ally gives her the fishmonger's report that Brad entered the cage before the four; under R27 those facts create a tampering hypothesis, making Del's first mandatory action a formal fishmonger statement and cage canvass followed by questioning Brad's early access. The tapes have expired, but Brad becomes the only known pre-opening visitor and principal suspected swapper before episode six.

Wrong if: Tessa's statement is unavailable to the detective receiving Ally's tip, or R27 requires proof rather than the hypothesis its wording specifies.

1. **B6 row 63 + C8 / A5, Day 325: the landlady. Confidence 98%.** The landlady lawfully knows the unique panel is on her lodger's wall when its ground, lettering, crack and private mark are described publicly; combined with Brad's photograph and aired habits, this identifies her lodger before the panel disappears. She takes that information to local police, whose first mandatory action is to attend, establish the lodger's identity and notify Del. C8 itself says that route puts a constable on her doorstep.

Wrong if: The landlady has never seen the panel clearly enough to recognise it despite C8 listing it among what she knows, or the Day 325 description omits its unique features.

1. **Round Two finding 8 repair, B1 rows 10a and 10c / A5, Day 311: the skipper. Confidence 97%.** The ledger says the deckhand lived aboard and drank at Brad's flat, but A5 has the skipper report that he "lodged with Brad Collins"; the skipper cannot lawfully supply that stronger fact. Del's first mandatory action on the actual information is to formalise the drinking-association statement, update the older missing-person file and run both names, not act on a nonexistent lodging link.

Wrong if: The deckhand really lodged at Brad's, which would require the boat-address history and the accepted Round Two repair to be rewritten.

Whole-graph recomputation

Person	Earliest day	Combined facts
Brad	17	He wrote the letter and possesses the genuine panel.
Margo	51–53	The false money claim, Brad's debt and his sustained steering name him as the forger; the actionable contradiction existed on Day 19.
Del	290	Tessa's cupboard statement plus the fishmonger's sighting name Brad as the suspected swapper.
Ally	300	The fishmonger's tip plus Tessa's screenshot produce the same conclusion.
Fishmonger	304	His sighting plus the aired statement that the cupboard object was wrong reveal the significance of Brad's visit.
Ruby, Liam and Tessa	311	The letters plus the aired analysis that the forgery protects exactly one man name Brad.
Landlady	325	The unique panel in her lodger's room plus its public description, photograph and habits name Brad as alive.

The rucksack repair holds: No. 14's build excludes Liam but cannot identify Brad from every other man in the city, so the Day 222 review does not reach the market under R27. The card also holds: Tessa's screenshot names neither a cupboard nor a person and creates no pre-Day 219 route. No unavoidable photo-identification event exists in Brad's cash-only second life, and the revived deckhand file produces no cross-force hit until an officer queries the borrowed identity.